Toronto Metropolitan University

Meaford Moves + Final Report

Winter 2023

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1.0 Introduction

Meaford is a lower-tier municipality located in Grey County in Ontario, Canada, 2 hours north of Toronto. The population was 11,485 in 2021, classifying Meaford as a small town. The town is heavily situated along Highway 26, where most services are located. The majority of residents live in single detached housing and private housing. Most families consist of 4 persons or less, with an overwhelming majority being two persons and couples without children. Very few residents live in other types of housing. According to Statistics Canada, out of 11,485 people in the town, 10,730 residents' first language is English. Out of all residents, 8,625 identify with European origins, 290 identify with First Nations origins, 190 identify with Asian/West Asian origins, 90 identify with Caribbean origins, 45 identify with African origins, and 45 identify with South American origins. The median age of the population is 53, making Meaford a prime location to develop properly accessible transit services for the aging population. According to Statistics Canada, 18% of Ontarians (the province in which Meaford is located) identify with having a disability. These statistics show that municipalities nationwide must take action to prevent older adult isolation and inaccessibility.

The following maps showcase demographic data within Meaford. The first map depicts that Meaford has an aging population, as most of the area indicates it is occupied by residents aged 42+. The second map showcases average income levels within Meaford.

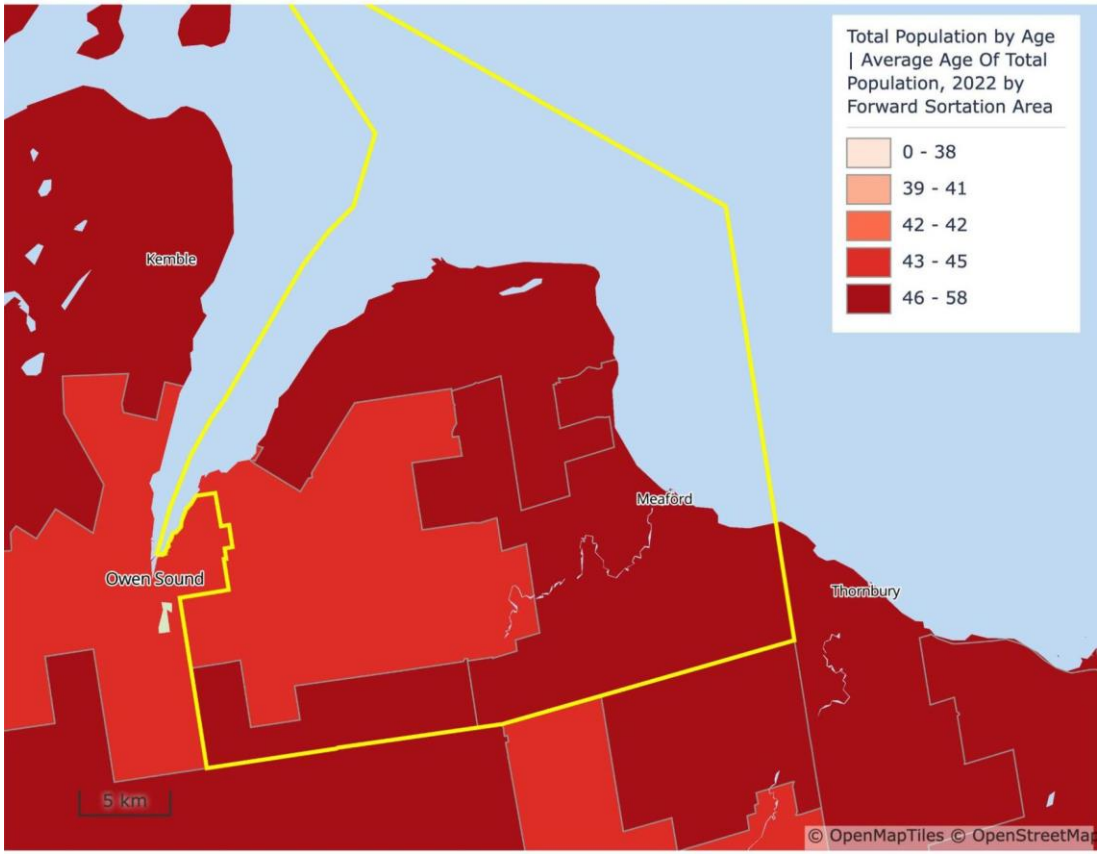

Figure 1. Meaford Total Population by Age 2022

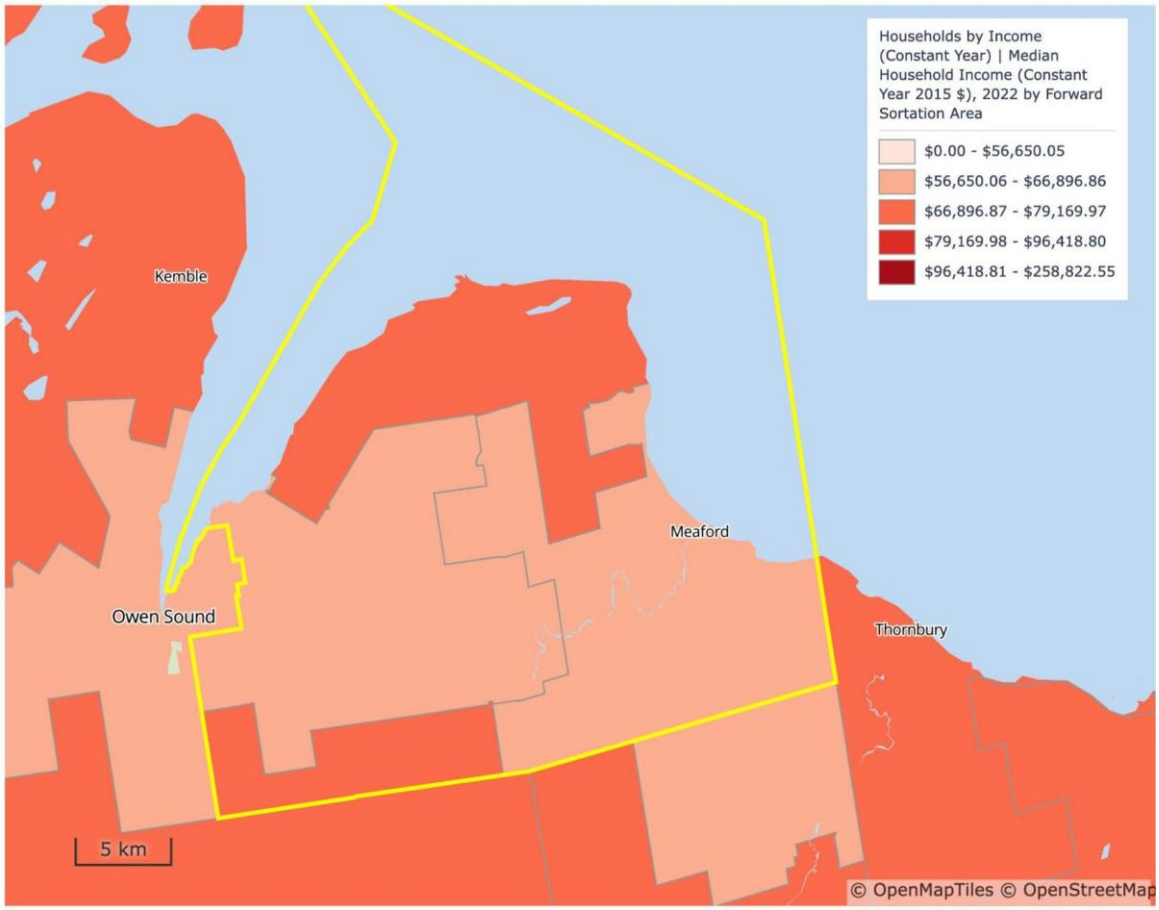

Figure 2. Meaford Households by Income 2022

2.0 Current Challenges

According to Statistics Canada, 1 in 4 Canadians suffer from a disability (visible or invisible). Disabilities create many challenges for individuals living with them, including how they commute, how they navigate space and their ability to access spaces. Cities and smaller municipalities must develop affordable and accessible transit for individuals living with disabilities to make their lives easier. Currently, the municipality of Meaford is facing challenges with its transportation accessibility and variety of service. The community relies heavily on personal vehicles, and essential services, e.g., grocery stores, hospitals, and dentists are only walkable for some residents. The downtown quarter on highway 26 features many food options and services condensed into one area. However, residents living south of this road who need access to a personal vehicle will experience tremendous challenges getting to the downtown core. The municipality currently has a transportation service in place called Meaford Moves+. The municipality publicly funds this program and the if population growth exceeds expected predictions, the municipality may need more resources to expand the service.

The goal of this service is to provide affordable and accessible transportation to older adults living with disabilities. Although Meaford Moves+ does exist within the current Well-Being Plan, it may not be accessible to all older residents, especially those with chronic illnesses such as dementia and Parkinson's disease. These residents may face challenges with directions, walking and trouble obtaining information about Meaford's transportation services. To sign up for Meaford Moves, a resident must complete a Specialized Transit Application Form. The type of application may not be accessible to all older adults as they may have trouble finding the form, filling it out, or finding where to submit it. Older adults are often isolated from current events and information because they might not own cellular devices or have access to the internet in their homes.

Regarding weather-related challenges, Meaford usually acquires 87 days of snow yearly. Combined with extreme cold and icy conditions, there is the possibility for closures within the service. If a patron needs an urgent service, these weather-related cancelations can be challenging for residents. The icy road conditions also make it more dangerous for the driver and passenger in the car.

With my vision, my goal is to address all of these current challenges to promote accessibility, safety, reliability, and trust within the Meaford community and its transit users.

Figure 3. Current Meaford Moves+ Vehicle

3.0 Vision and Strategy

My vision and strategy consist of the following goals:

- To provide a safe, comfortable and reliable accessible transportation option for older adults and persons with disabilities.
- To Expand Meafords current transportation system/ routes to accommodate more people and their needs.
- Allow for more information to be accessible to older adults about the service.
- Provide older adults services that teach them about transit in Meaford, how to get around, and popular places to visit.
- Expand the operation time from 8:00 am-4:00 pm to 7:00 am-6:00 pm.
- Include at least 1 additional day per week (either add Monday or a day on the weekend)
- Accommodate fares for low-income families/ individuals.
- Commitment to making health appointments headache free and flexible for customers

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With regards to getting the message about the Meaford Moves + service to older adults, I propose giving older adults the option to have a personal support worker come to their house to assist them in filling out all the necessary documentation in order to participate in the service. I also propose increasing awareness of the service within communities of older adults, by having Meaford Moves staff visit the homes of older adults in various neighborhoods and explain the service to the residents. I also propose having this be something that can be done by high school students who are trying to get their 40 hours of community service completed, they can work with Meaford Moves staff and coordinate spreading the word of the service to older adults in the neighbourhood. Overall, this should help to decrease the barriers and isolation many older adults face when trying to access public services as more often information is being offered in a digital format which can cause technological challenges for older adults.

4.0 Current Service and Possible Improvements

Meaford Moves follows the municipality's "Specialized Transit Policy" aimed at providing accessible transportation for people with disabilities at their respective locations (Municipality of Meaford, 2018). The service utilizes definitions of disability as prescribed by the Ontario Humans Rights Code and outlines appropriate definitions of "Regulated Health Professionals" that could recommend the transportation service to their patients. Particularly, eligibility for the assistance can be stratified into levels of mobility such as "the inability to walk 400 metres on even ground" or conditions that alter an individual's mobility, for instance, the loss of a driver's license from medical conditions. Meaford currently separates applicants into two categories of differing mobility, unconditional and temporary. Unconditional includes individuals with chronic and permanent disabilities, and temporary includes access to individuals who have temporary disabilities either due to unforeseen accidents or lifestyle changes (Municipality of Meaford, 2018).

To utilize the specialized service, individuals must submit an “Accessible Transit Application Form” that asks applicants for their personal information, including but not limited to address, name of a long-term care home, phone, email, emergency contact, supporting documentation, healthcare professional recommendations and use of mobility devices (Municipality of Meaford, 2023). If accepted by the municipality’s Accessibility Coordinator, the applicant will receive an identification card, valid for three years, that must be shown to the operator of a vehicle to gain entry; the card will also highlight additional information such as support personnel if the cardholder requires so for transport (Municipality of Meaford, 2018). Moreover, if the rider necessitates a support animal, they are required to be certified, and certificates must be made available to operators at their request; if no certificate is available, the animal will be unable to join the person for their ride (Municipality of Meaford, 2018).

The service operates on a flexible schedule and serviceability depending on the needs of booked users. Operators are responsible for notifying residents when the vehicle arrives by tapping or buzzing their doors (Municipality of Meaford, 2018). Currently, operators can arrive at their scheduled pick-up locations 15 minutes ahead of time or 15 minutes delayed and depending on operator discretion plus the condition of roads and traffic, a delay beyond 30 minutes will trigger a dispatcher to notify prospective passengers of said delay (Municipality of Meaford, 2018). Moreover, operators have been instructed to remain at pick-up locations for an additional 10 minutes if a customer is delayed, to protect against any unforeseen circumstances impeding their embarkment. Additionally, if the customer’s mobility devices conflict with the vehicle and the overall operation safety, the trip will be canceled by the operator; this assessment safeguards customer safety within and outside the vehicle (Municipality of Meaford, 2018).

Currently, Meaford Moves operates as a specialized mobility service catered towards individuals with disabilities or mobility impairments. The service’s operating hours, as of March 2023, are from Tuesday to Friday between 8:00 am and 4:00 pm (Municipality of Meaford, 2023). Local trips within the municipality of Meaford are fixed at 2 dollars, down from the initial 4 dollars. Trips outside the municipality usually for healthcare services cost 8 dollars; these trips are specific to adjacent Grey County cities and municipalities, namely, Owen Sound, Thornbury, and Collingwood (Municipality of Meaford, 2023). Costs are established through The Corporation of the Municipality of Meaford’s By-Law under fees and schedule “G” beginning in 2021, the fare price became established (Municipality of Meaford, 2021). These costs are one-way and eligible passengers are allowed to bring up to two additional passengers for added costs; however, if the individual is a caregiver, their ride is free of charge (Municipality of Meaford, 2023).

Ideas for Improvements in Service Provision

- Increasing Taxi Rates to substantiate expansion of Meaford Move's accessible transit service from four days a week to a possible five or six.

- Provide additional payment options such as a monthly pass system for better system funding, making boarding times faster as caregivers or individuals do not need to muddle around with payment.

- Look into adding a program for volunteers wishing to help support Meaford Moves like those in HCSS Grey-Bruce County. Requiring the implementation of a certification system for prospective drivers that enables them to drive/ help the disabled and mobility impaired.

- Of service levels, Meaford Moves is the lowest, with only four days of service for residents, making it difficult for residents to book appointments without considering the vehicle schedule. Ease of use significantly decreases as seniors/ people with disabilities must account for vehicle availability during bookings. Ideally, I would want to increase service by **1** or **2** days to allow for unrestricted movement of citizens and booking of health services. I also would like to expand operating hours from 8:00 am to 4:00 pm to 7:00 am to 6:00 pm, an overall increase of 3 hours.

- Expanding the service to those without mobility issues; for low-income teens and adults who need to travel across town, adds more revenue for the system. Of course, people with disabilities will be prioritized, but the municipality can gauge how full the vehicle is on a daily basis if there are unused empty seats; an application that updates between trips for residents would allow individuals willing to use the system to request a pick-up.

- Further study of ridership and locations of interest would help create the most frequented routes within Meaford, which could inform better route planning exercises.

- Avoiding ridership cannibalization through Taxi rates/third-party transit service partnerships.

- Raise awareness of the program through door-to-door advertising from volunteers from locals/ students that need their 40 hours.

- A partnership with the three major & minor medical locations outside of Meaford, a collaboration between the municipality and selected hospitals/ health services frequented by the users; to provide funding for a) a **better vehicle or additional one for added operating hours/ mileage**, b) **Better access to follow-up appointments/ flexibility for dialysis patients** c) **More funding for adding a new operator that can work when another cannot**.

- Consider a service amnesty clause similar to HCSS, where service outside the prescribed schedule can occur but would cost the customer slightly more. ($2 Inside Meaford, $8 Outside Meaford) to ($4 Inside Meaford, $14 Outside Meaford)

5.0 Comparison to Parallel Services in Bruce & Grey County

Collingwood (Grey County)

Similar to the Municipality of Meaford, Collingwood, also within Grey County, adopted an accessible bus service for riders with disabilities and mobility limited persons. The "TransitPLUS" service operates between Collingwood, Wasaga Beach and Clearview Township beginning on December 19, 2022. Similarly, applying for the service requires pre-registration online or by phone. The service requires customers to book three days in advance for rides between 8:30 am and 5:00 pm and service after 5:00 between 6:00 pm and 9:00 pm; there are no such restrictions as the service respects immediate requests. Unlike Meaford, Collingwood's service provision is seven days a week, from 7:00 am to 9:00 pm, with fare prices lower for seniors and students by 50 cents (Town of Collingwood, 2023). Collingwood's fare system, as of January 2023, also allows for monthly pass purchases (Town of Collingwood, 2023). To better illustrate perceived differences, the chart below displays Collingwood's fare structuring compared to Meaford's.

Port Elgin (Bruce County)

Port Elgin, compared to Meaford, lacks the same level of transit afforded to disabled and mobility-limited individuals. For instance, their level of transit provision is dominated by private providers through taxis, school bus and fixed routes to select casinos. The only practical mode of travel within the community is a fixed trolley bus, "Saugeen Shores S.S.," which operates between Port Elgin and Southampton; however, the service has ceased operation due to extenuating circumstances related to the pandemic (McCormack, 2022). However, the county does possess Saugeen Mobility and Regional Transit (SMART), a specialized service that provides transit in a 20km radius encompassing Arran-Elderslie, Brockton, Hanover, Huron Kinloss, Chatsworth, Kincardine, Saugeen Shores, Southgate, and West Grey (SMART, 2023). Compared to Meaford, SMART operates six days a week compared to 4, with Sunday being the only day rendered inoperable, including holidays.

Fare Type (One-way)	Meaford (Meaford Moves +)	Collingwood (TransitPLUS)
Adults	$2 ($8 Out of limits)	$2
Seniors	$2 ($8 Out of limits)	$1.50
Children	$2 ($8 Out of limits)	$1.50
Monthly Pass	$2 ($8 Out of limits)	$50.00 Adult $30.00 Seniors 60+/ Students $40.00 Collingwood to Blue Mountains Link

Figure 4. Comparison of Fare Prices Between Meaford and Collingwood

The difference between Meaford Moves and TransitPLUS is that Collingwood offers better service provision operating seven days a week compared to 4 days for Meaford. Moreover, unlike TransitPLUS, Meaford Moves possess a fixed cost for towns outside the municipality, a service that TransitPLUS does not provide. Despite these differences, Collingwood is justifiably a bigger town than Meaford; by nature, they are more capable of providing these services as they have a more extensive tax base.

Applicable Townships for Grey Transit Route - GTR (Grey County)

For towns utilizing Grey County's overarching transit service, the Grey Transit Route (GTR) possesses six routes connecting Owen Sound to Orangeville and the Town of the Blue Mountains (Grey County, 2023). The service also joins Owen Sound to Wiarton and Flesherton with Walkerton (Grey County, 2023). Routes 1 & 2 operate along Highway 10 and connect Owen Sound to Dundalk, Dundalk with Orangeville. Route 1 & 2 operates Monday through Friday. Routes 2 & 3 operate between Owen Sound, Meaford and Blue Mountain along Highway 26, providing service Monday through Sunday. Route 5 connects Owen Sound with Wiarton and differs between seasonal services. For months outside of summer, the route operates Monday through Friday. During the summer, route five operates Monday through Sunday. Lastly, route 6 links Flesherton with Walkerton between Monday and Friday. Below is a comparison of GTR with Meaford's accessible transit service.

Operating Hours	Meaford	Collingwood	Grey Transit Route (Hanover etc.)	SMART (Port Elgin etc.)	Owen Sound Transit
Beginning	8:00am	7:00am	Route Dependent Between 6:45am & 8:46am	6:00am Mon-Fri 7:00am Sat	6:30am Mon-Fri 9:00am Sat
Ending	4:00pm	9:00pm	Route Dependent Between 1:20pm &8:59pm	6:00am Mon-Thur 12:00am Fri 12:00am Sat	6:00pm Mon-Fri 4:00pm Sat
Days/ week	**4**	**7**	**5**/ Mon to Fri or Wed to Sun (Depending on Route)	**6**	**5**

Figure 5. Comparison of Operating Hours Between Meaford and Parallel Services

Due to GTR retaining differing fare prices depending on routing, I will compare averages across all routes with Meaford.

Fare Type (One-way)	Meaford (Meaford Moves+)	Grey Transit Route (GTR)
Children (Under 5)	$2 ($8 Out of Limits)	Free
Adult	$2 ($8 Out of Limits)	$4.50/avg
Senior & Student	$2 ($8 Out of Limits)	$4.00/avg

Figure 6. Comparison of Fare Prices Between Meaford and Grey Transit Route

Fare Type (One-way)	Meaford (Meaford Moves+)	Saugeen Mobility and Regional Transit (SMART)
Adults	$2	Minimum $7.50
Seniors/ Children	$2	Minimum $7.50
Out of Limits (Medical)	$8	$22.00/h +$0.55/km

Figure 7. Comparison of Fare Prices Between Meaford and Saugeen Mobility and Regional Transit

Unlike Meaford Moves, SMART has a per/km travelled payment scheme with minimum rides costing 7.50 dollars per customer. The payment begins at a base value of 2 dollars and rises a fixed 55 cents per kilometre subsequently. Moreover, further stops requested by customers will cost an additional 2.50 dollars. Compared to the Meaford, SMART's system is difficult for seniors to calculate as fixed costs are straightforward to plan for compared to a per-kilometre system. There is also a penalty incurred for customers that delay the SMART service over an hour; individuals will need to pay 22 dollars if the wait is longer than one hour (SMART, 2023).

Home & Community Support Services (HCSS) Grey-Bruce County

HCSS is a service offered between residents of the neighbouring counties, Grey and Bruce. The service is offered to individuals 18 years of age plus with disabilities or those with current mobility issues (HCSS, 2023). The service allows individuals to run errands and access distant medical resources; the amenity is partly provided by volunteers and paid personnel. Volunteers utilize their personal vehicles to transport clients, and a van picks-up clients with further pressing mobility needs. HCSS operates six days a week from Monday to Saturday for 12 hours, beginning at 7:00 am and ending at 7:00 pm (HCS,2023). The service stops on Sundays; however, if a client's important medical requirement falls upon a Sunday, HCSS will find a way to accommodate their schedules (HCSS, 2023).

Fares and fees were difficult to come by for the HCSS service; however, according to a promotional report for roundtrips under 20km and 1.5 hours in length, clients are charged 10 dollars, with 9 dollars paid directly to volunteer drivers. For contracted drivers, there needed to be more data; however, from HCSS's 2021-2022 report, there are eight paid drivers and 54 volunteers providing transportation services. Due to the pandemic, HCSS lost 100 volunteers for this service (HCSS, 2022).

First Student Canada (211)

This is a charter service offered in northern Grey County near Owen Sound. Specializing in transporting students with disabilities alongside adults, the service is appointment based, either through email or by calling. The service is available five days a week, from Monday through Friday. Operating from 8:00 am until 4:30 pm. The service is partly provided through trained operators utilizing either commercial vehicles such as buses or commuter vehicles such as sedans and minivans. As of 2023, the pricing scheme has yet to be publicized online.

Owen Sound (Grey County)

Likewise, Owen Sound also possesses a mobility service catered toward people with disabilities. The service is also door-to-door and allows customers to book ahead of time; the vehicle is comparable to that of Toronto's Ford Minibuses, with wheelchair accessibility (Owen Sound, 2023). Unlike Meaford, Owen Sound's Mobility Transit Service has a monthly pass system similar to Collingwood's. Below is a comparison of fare prices between Owen Sound and Meaford.

Fare Type (One-way)	Meaford (Meaford Moves +)	Owen Sound (MTS)
Child	$2 ($8 Out of limits)	Free
Students	$2 ($8 Out of limits)	$2.50
Adults & Seniors	$2 ($8 Out of limits)	$3.00
Monthly Pass	None	$70.00 Adults $55.00 Seniors $35.00 Students $0.00 Preschoolers

Figure 8. Comparison of Fare Prices Between Meaford and Owen Sound

Comparison of Monthly Pass Systems Collingwood TransitPLUS vs. Owen Sound MTS

Fare Type (Monthly Pass)	Owen Sound (MTS)	Collingwood (TransitPLUS)
Students	$35.00	$30.00
Seniors	$55.00	$30.00
Adults	$70.00	$50.00

Figure 9. Comparison of Monthly Pass Systems Between Owen Sound and Collingwood

At a glance, the monthly pass system is cheaper for seniors and adults living in Collingwood. Would Meaford benefit from a monthly pass system that encourages the use of mobility services? The benefits of the monthly pass system allow for larger cash injections for necessities such as vehicle maintenance and driver salary. By having payment start every month instead of a moving fixed price system, the Meaford Moves program is better suited to adapting to unexpected circumstances such as mechanical breakdowns and service-related issues such as snowstorms.

At a Glance Fare Price/ Service Provision Comparison Chart

Comparing between Meaford (Meaford Moves +), Owen Sound (MTS), Collingwood (Transit-PLUS), Saugeen Mobility and Regional Transit (SMART), Grey County (GTR), Home & Community Support Services Grey-Bruce County

Fare Price/ Operational Capacity	Meaford (Meaford Moves+)	Owen Sound (MTS)	Collingwood (TransitPLUS)	Saugeen Mobility and Regional Transit (SMART)	Grey County (GTR) across all 6 routes	Home & Community Support Services Grey-Bruce (HCCS)
Child Fare	**$2.00** ($8.00 Outside of Limits)	Free	**$1.50**	Min $7.50($22 Outside of Limits + $0.55/km)	Free (Under 5)	No data
Student Fare	**$2.00** ($8.00 Outside of Limits)	**$2.50**	**$1.50**	Min $7.50($22 Outside of Limits + $0.55/km)	**$4.00**/avg	No data
Adult Fare	**$2.00** ($8.00 Outside of Limits)	**$3.00**	**$2.00**	Min $7.50($22 Outside of Limits + $0.55/km)	**$4.50**/avg	**$10**
Senior Fare	**$2.00** ($8.00 Outside of Limits)	**$3.00**	**$1.50**	Min $7.50($22 Outside of Limits + $0.55/km)	**$4.00**/avg	**$10**
Monthly Pass System	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	No
Daily Operating Hours	**8** Hours	**11.5** Hours on Weekdays **7** Hours on Satudays	**14** Hours	**12** Hours Monday-Thursday **18** Hours-Friday **17** Hours- Saturday	Route Dependent ~**1.5** Hours to **12** Hours	**12** Hours
Operating Days per Week	**4**	**5**	**7**	**6**	**5** - Days vary from Mon to Fri or Wed to Sun (Route Dependent)	**6** Variable depending on conditions (7 Theoretical)

Figure 10. At a Glance Fare Price and Service Provision Comparison Chart

Predicted Goals of Implementations

Through my various proposed implementations I hope to increase overall awareness of the Meaford Moves+ service and reduce some of the technological barriers that older adults often face when they want to access public services. I hope to have a service that can accommodate older adults and people with disabili-ties by having a flexible service that ensures fairness and freedom of travel. Mem-bers of the community will hopefully be able to access their medical appointments while also having the opportunity to engage in social visits to friends and family.

7.0 Future Improvements and Conclusion

There are a couple of factors that should be taken into consideration which includes the amount of seniors that are being affected and the lack of accessibility. According to the demographics:

Ages 65 - 69	Ages 70 - 74	Ages 75 - 79	Ages 80 - 84	Ages 85 +	Total
1,135	1,005	645	450	365	3,600

Figure 11. Number of Seniors by Age Group in Meaford

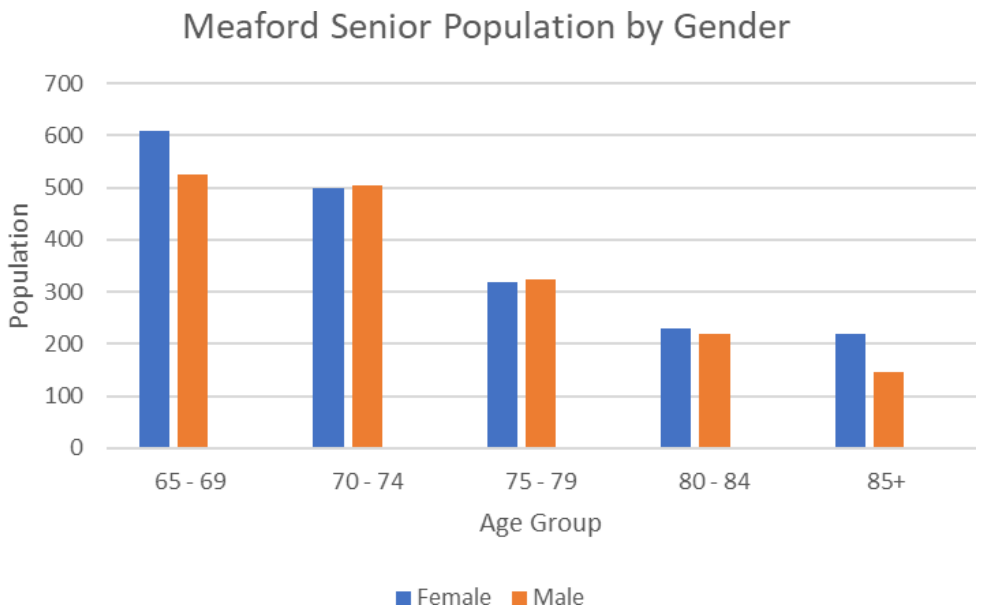

Figure 12. Meaford Senior Population by Gender

In the process of taking accessibility and safety more seriously, the seniors should arguably be the first priority. After doing further analysis and research, it has been proven through several studies that gender plays a role in the aging community as well (Stibich, 2022). Just by looking at the numbers, the gender population of the seniors are relatively similar as there seems to be only 160 more female seniors as compared to male which also supports the fact that usually women live longer than men. Regardless, seniors experience numerous disabilities which include mobility issues, eyesight or hearing loss as well. According to studies from Harvard University, women tend to live longer than men which is due to many reasons including, medical issues such as high blood pressure and lower estrogen levels (Shmerling, 2020). Moreover, men tend to have more social isolation with the world which has proven to higher death rates and they tend to avoid doctors as they routinely skip health screens. Regarding cognitive impairments, it seems that there are different factors for both genders as it's more common for men to be overweight, deal with diabetes or have had strokes. Also, it's more common for females who are heavily dependent on others and don't have a strong social network. At the end of the day, seniors tend to visit the hospitals more often than other age groups and spend a lot of their time in social circles such as senior community centers.

After conducting further research, it is clear that Meaford needs more accessibility for seniors to commute to certain areas that are not within walking distance. This is due to the fact that all of the senior related services tend to be within the Owen Sound area. Some of these places include the "Central Place Retirement Community" (retirement home), "Sounds Lifestyles Ltd" (Senior citizen center), "Revera Summit Place" (retirement community), "Active Lifestyles seniors Centre" (organization) and the "St. Francis Place" (social services). The drive from Meaford to these places is about 25 minutes, but the issue is that a public transit takes about 40 to 70 minutes (buses 3 and 4) which is not very convenient for seniors especially if the weather conditions are not the best due to snow or ice as it could lead to more falls. Moreover, if they can't get reliable transportation to these places then that could lead to even more social isolation issues. Also, regarding health clinics and hospitals I believe that Meaford does just about an average job at the amount of facilities available for residents. There seems to be a great amount of dental care options and pharmaceutical places including “Rexall” or the “Meaford IDA Pharmacy”. Although, it seems that there aren’t enough options for seniors to reach out to doctors as the closest major hospital is the “Grey Bruce Health Services” which is located in Owen Sound. Furthermore, Meaford should learn to conduct similar services as compared to the city of Brampton who are considered to have the 5th best public transportation system in Canada (News Wire, 2019). This is highly due to the fact that not only do they have the Brampton Transit, but they also have “Zum” which supports high capacity routes and it has “world-class technologies to provide better and faster ways to connect people and places” (City of Brampton, 2023). This system has fewer stops, reaches destinations in less time, real time next bus information, high back plush seats and transit signal priority technology which assists buses to stay on schedule (City of Brampton, 2023).

Also, there are not many options in regards to everyday basic places which includes grocery stores which people of all ages go to. Majority of the major grocery stores are in Owen Sound as this includes “Zehrs”, “Foodland”, “Food Basics”, “Metro” and “NoFrills”. The “Godard’s Your Independent Grocer” seems to be the most popular grocery store within the city which still is nowhere near as popular as any of the one’s available in the city of Owen Sound. This goes out to show how important it is to have solid transportation access to that city.

Although, it seems that there aren’t enough options for seniors to reach out to doctors as the closest major hospital is the “Grey Bruce Health Services” which is located in Owen Sound. Furthermore, Meaford should learn to conduct similar services as compared to the city of Brampton who are considered to have the 5th best public transportation system in Canada (Redfin, 2019). This is highly due to the fact that not only do they have the Brampton Transit, but they also have “Zum” which supports high capacity routes and it has “world-class technologies to provide better and faster ways to connect people and places” (City of Brampton, 2023). This system has fewer stops, reaches destinations in less time, real time next bus information, high back plush seats and transit signal priority technology which assists buses to stay on schedule (City of Brampton, 2023).

Conclusion

Throughout all proven statistical categories, results and comparisons that I have conducted, it is evident that Meaford Moves+ should implement changes to develop a more sustainable transportation system through accessibility and affordability methods. Since Meaford is a small municipality it may not be as difficult to implement some changes, but this should be done through careful consideration of senior citizens and people with disabilities. This may include implementing procedures similar to other municipalities or implementing some of my considerations/ideas that were provided to ensure better solutions for the municipality.

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